



MARITIME CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS TRAINING

FACILITATOR GUIDE

FACILITATOR INSTRUCTIONS (READ FIRST)

You do **not** need to be a cybersecurity expert to lead this training.

Your role is to walk through the material, explain the examples, reinforce safe behaviors, and encourage discussion.

If someone asks a question you cannot answer, say: “That’s a great question. I’ll bring it to our cybersecurity team so you get the correct information.”

Keep the session practical and conversational. Discussions about abnormal behavior, near misses, and real-world examples are extremely valuable.

TRAINING SCRIPT (FACILITATOR READS ALOUD)

1. Introduction: Why Maritime Cybersecurity Awareness Matters

Today, we’re covering maritime cybersecurity awareness. This training is focused on recognizing cybersecurity threats that can affect waterfront facilities and vessels, and understanding how attackers may try to bypass security controls.

This training applies to anyone who works at, visits, or supports maritime operations at facilities or aboard vessels, whether your role is operational, maintenance, administrative, or supervisory.

You are not expected to fix cybersecurity problems. Your responsibility is to recognize when something seems unusual and report it promptly.

Cyber incidents affecting vessels or waterfront facilities often begin with activity that looks normal at first. Early awareness and reporting can prevent safety issues, environmental impacts, operational disruption, and security incidents.

2. Cybersecurity Threats and Cyber Incidents (What You Need to Know)

In the maritime environment, cybersecurity issues are best thought of in simple terms:

- Cybersecurity threats are actions, situations, or behaviors that could put systems at risk.
- A cyber incident is when that risk actually results in unauthorized harm.

Under U.S. Coast Guard regulations (33 CFR 101.615), a cyber incident is defined as:

An occurrence that actually jeopardizes, without lawful authority, the integrity, confidentiality, or availability of information or an information system, or actually jeopardizes, without lawful authority, an information system.

In practical terms, this means:

- Systems or data are changed without approval (**integrity**)
- Someone accesses systems or information without permission (**confidentiality**)



- Systems become unreliable, disrupted, or unavailable (**availability**)

Cybersecurity threats can affect:

- Information Technology (IT) systems (email, business systems, office computers)
- Operational Technology (OT) systems (equipment and systems that interact with the physical environment)

Some threats affect both at the same time.

Cybersecurity threats often look minor or routine at first and may not succeed. Even so, they should be taken seriously because they can lead to a cyber incident.

3. Common Cybersecurity Threats You May Encounter

Most cyber incidents start with everyday situations, not advanced hacking. Common examples include:

Phishing and Social Engineering

- Unexpected emails, texts, or phone calls
- Messages creating urgency ("act now," "account locked")
- Requests for passwords, access codes, or system access

Malware and Ransomware

- Unapproved software installations
- Pop-ups, crashes, or unexplained system slowdowns
- Files becoming inaccessible or renamed

Insider Risks (Intentional or Accidental)

- Sharing passwords or using someone else's login
- Leaving systems logged in and unattended
- Connecting personal or unapproved devices

OT-Related Indicators (If Applicable)

- Equipment operating without being commanded
- Screens freezing, flickering, or showing inconsistent data
- Alarms that don't match what's happening in the field

You don't need to know how these threats work. You only need to notice when something doesn't seem right.

4. Techniques Used to Circumvent Cybersecurity Measures

Attackers often bypass security by exploiting normal human behavior, not technical flaws.

Credential Misuse

- Using stolen, shared, or guessed passwords



- Asking someone else to log in “just this once”
- Using unattended or already logged-in systems

If someone asks you to log in for them, treat this as suspicious.

Physical Access and Portable Media

- Plugging in unknown or unapproved USB drives
- Connecting unauthorized laptops or tools
- Allowing equipment connections without approval

These actions bypass technical safeguards by using physical access instead of digital access.

Social Engineering and Trust Exploitation

- Pretending to be vendors, IT support, inspectors, or supervisors
- Using real names or job titles to gain trust
- Creating urgency to avoid verification

Being polite does not mean skipping verification.

Convenience-Based Circumvention

- Propping open secured doors
- Disabling security features to save time
- Using shared or generic accounts

These actions weaken security even when intentions are good.

5. How to Recognize When Something Is Wrong

You do not need to diagnose the problem. Signs of suspicious cyber activity may include:

- Systems or equipment behaving unexpectedly
- Screens freezing, flickering, or displaying incorrect information
- Loss of communication with systems or devices
- Login failures with correct credentials
- New alarms or alerts without explanation
- Unknown devices, cables, or USB drives connected
- Requests to access systems or equipment outside normal procedures

When in doubt, treat unexpected behavior as suspicious and report it.

6. What To Do If You Notice Something

If you see something unusual, report it right away. You will never get in trouble for reporting a concern that turns out to be nothing.

**Report to:**

1. Supervisor / Operations Lead
2. Facility / Vessel / Company Security Officer (FSO / VSO / CSO)
3. IT ServiceDesk
4. Cybersecurity Officer (CySO)

Note for facilitator: If asked whether to shut something down, say, "Follow safety procedures. For cybersecurity questions, contact the CySO."

7. Third-Party and Vendor Awareness

Vendors, contractors, and other third parties must follow approved cybersecurity procedures.

You should never allow any third party to:

- Plug into systems or equipment without authorization
- Access systems remotely without prior approval and scheduling
- Perform work outside the scope of what has been authorized

If you aren't sure, stop and ask or say, "I need to check with our cybersecurity team before we proceed."

8. Wrap-Up

Your awareness is one of the strongest cybersecurity defenses we have. You are responsible for:

- Protecting your login credentials
- Keeping secure areas secure
- Reporting unusual behavior
- Using only approved tools and devices
- Following established procedures
- Asking questions instead of guessing

If something feels unusual, report it. If you're unsure, ask. **If you see something, say something.**

Facilitator questions for the group:

If you have time, use the discussion prompts below to open a dialogue with trainees:

- *What unusual system behavior have you seen in the past?*
- *Who would you contact first if something seemed off?*

Remind employees they won't be penalized for reporting.